An Old Space Game Is Coming Back

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Fans of old video games got good news this weekend. At the Portland Retro Gaming Expo, a big event for classic games, a **producer** from Electronic Arts made an announcement. The game Wing Commander 3: Heart of the Tiger is getting a **remaster**. A **remaster** is a new, improved version of an old game.

Wing Commander was a popular series of space flying games for computers in the 1990s.

The **producer**, Jim Vessella, said he found the original tapes from when the game was made. A fan said he found more than 600 tapes.

The new version will be for the game's 30th **anniversary**. Its videos will be cleaned up, and it will run more smoothly. It may also include the first three games.

In the game, players fly as a space pilot fighting giant cat-like aliens called the Kilrathi. The game has movie scenes with real **actors**, including Mark Hamill, who played Luke Skywalker in Star Wars.

Word Treasure

producer -- A person who helps plan and make a game, movie or show.

remaster -- A new, improved version of an old game.

anniversary -- A special day that marks how many years have passed since something happened.

actors -- People who play characters in movies, shows or games.

Background you need

Video games from the 1990s often had blurry pictures compared with games today.

A remaster makes an old game look and play better.

Some old games had movie scenes filmed with real actors.

Break it down

WHO: Electronic Arts producer Jim Vessella and Wing Commander fans
WHAT: A new, improved version of the 1990s space game Wing Commander 3
WHERE: Announced at the Portland Retro Gaming Expo
WHY: He found the game's original tapes and the game turns 30

Why it matters

Fixing up old games lets kids today play classics their parents may have loved.

Test what you remember

1. Which game is getting a remaster?

(A) Pac-Man
(B) Star Wars
(C) Wing Commander 3: Heart of the Tiger
(D) Minecraft

2. What is a remaster?

(A) A new, improved version of an old game
(B) A broken game
(C) A board game
(D) A movie ticket

3. Where was the news shared?

(A) A school library
(B) The Moon
(C) A TV cooking show
(D) Portland Retro Gaming Expo

4. What did producer Jim Vessella find?

(A) A new planet
(B) The original tapes from making the game
(C) An old phone
(D) A lost cat

5. Who do players fight in the game?

(A) Giant cat-like aliens called the Kilrathi
(B) Dragons
(C) Robots from the ocean
(D) Pirates

6. Which actor from Star Wars is in the game's movie scenes?

(A) Mark Hamill
(B) Sombr
(C) Lindsey Buckingham
(D) Kevin Fennessy

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: D 4: B 5: A 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Jim Vessella: Says a 30th anniversary remaster of Wing Commander 3 is coming.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):